Beta discounts shown to every storefront customer for two hours

INC-5517 · SEV-2 · author N. Vogel (Commerce Platform) · final version 2026-06-15

DURATION	ORDERS AFFECTED	MARGIN LOST	DEPLOYMENTS
2h 06m	**4,310**	**CHF 61,700**	**0**
10:56 - 13:02 CEST, 2026-06-09	placed at the beta price	all orders honoured	no application change that day

Jira issue	INC-5517 · actions COM-770 to COM-773
Severity	SEV-2 (major)
Resolved	2026-06-09 13:02 CEST
Affected systems	toggle (feature flag service), storefront-web, pricing-service
Incident lead	N. Vogel

What happened

At 10:56 CEST on 9 June 2026 every customer of the Swiss storefront began seeing the beta discount programme: 12% off selected home and garden categories, which had been exposed to 5% of logged-in customers since 20 May. The merchandising team noticed the margin dashboard diverging at 11:30 and raised the incident at 11:41. The discount was withdrawn at 13:02 by correcting a single flag value.

No application deployment took place on 9 June. pricing-service was last deployed on 2 June and storefront-web on 4 June; both were ruled out in the first twenty minutes of the investigation. The only production change that morning was the upgrade of the feature flag service, toggle, from 2.14 to 3.0 at 10:54.

Root cause

> toggle 3.0 changed the meaning of a flag's `rollout` field from a percentage (0–100) to a fraction (0.0–1.0), and clamps any value above 1.0 to 1.0. The flag `pricing.beta-discounts` held the value 5, meaning 5% under 2.x; under 3.0 it was read as 5.0, clamped to 1.0, and served to 100% of customers. The upgrade shipped a migration script that divides every rollout by 100, but the script only walks flags created through the toggle UI. Flags in the `pricing` namespace are managed by Terraform and were never migrated.

Timeline (CEST, 2026-06-09)

Time	Event
10:54	toggle upgraded 2.14 → 3.0 (change COM-CHG-2208). UI migration script runs; 212 flags migrated.
10:56	pricing.beta-discounts begins evaluating true for every customer.
11:30	Merchandising sees gross margin 9 points below forecast.
11:41	INC-5517 raised, SEV-2. N. Vogel leads.
11:58	Deployment history checked: nothing deployed to pricing or storefront since 4 June.
12:31	Flag evaluation logs show 100% true for the beta flag since 10:56; toggle upgrade correlated.
12:47	Unit change in toggle 3.0 release notes identified.
13:02	Rollout set to 0.05 via Terraform. Discount withdrawn. Resolved.

Action plan

Jira	Action	Owner	Due	Status
COM-770	Migrate every Terraform-managed flag to fractional rollout and add a plan-time check that rejects rollout values above 1.0.	N. Vogel	2026-06-19	Done
COM-771	Treat flag service upgrades as production changes requiring a diff of effective evaluation for the top 50 flags.	L. Reber	2026-06-30	Done
COM-772	Alert when any pricing flag's true-rate changes by more than 10 points in 5 minutes.	A. Novak	2026-06-26	Done
COM-773	Margin-divergence alert for merchandising, paging at 3 points below forecast for 15 minutes.	N. Vogel	2026-07-03	Done